

Installing SteamCMD on Debian

2025-11-01

1 Overview

component	name	version	notes
OS	Debian GNU/Linux	13 (trixie)	latest as of 2025-11-01
kernel	Linux	6.12.48+deb13-amd64	
	SteamCMD	0~20180105-5	package name: steamcmd ¹ , executable: /usr/games/steamcmd

2 Configure Architecture

```
# dpkg --add-architecture i386
# apt update
```

3 Configure Non-Free Area

Edit /etc/apt/sources.list.d/debian.sources, which looks like the following by default:

```
Types: deb deb-src
URIs: mirror+file:///etc/apt/mirrors/debian.list
Suites: trixie trixie-updates trixie-backports
Components: main
Signed-By: /usr/share/keyrings/debian-archive-keyring.gpg

Types: deb deb-src
URIs: mirror+file:///etc/apt/mirrors/debian-security.list
Suites: trixie-security
Components: main
Signed-By: /usr/share/keyrings/debian-archive-keyring.gpg
```

Add non-free to Components:

```
4c4
< Components: main
---
> Components: main non-free
```

```
# apt update
```

¹<https://packages.debian.org/trixie/steamcmd> (accessed 2025-11-01)

4 Install SteamCMD

```
# apt install steamcmd
```

The installer is interactive: You'll need to accept some terms.

The package installs the program in a weird location: `/usr/games/steamcmd`, which isn't even in the default `$PATH`. Create a link to the executable in a more sensible location.

```
# ln -s /usr/games/steamcmd /usr/bin/steamcmd
```

(The corresponding package for Arch Linux² installs in `/usr/bin/steamcmd`.)

SteamCMD updates itself outside of the system package manager. As of 2025-11-01, the latest version seems to be 1759461699, as reported by the program when run with `--help`.

```
# steamcmd --help
[ 0%] Checking for available updates...
[----] Verifying installation...
Steam Console Client (c) Valve Corporation - version 1759461699
```

The version number 1759461699 translates to 2025-10-03 03:21:39 UTC, if interpreted as a Unix timestamp, which seems reasonable as of 2025-11-01.

²<https://aur.archlinux.org/packages/steamcmd> (accessed 2025-11-01)